

*In today's world of trending diets and conflicting nutrition advice, eating well can feel unnecessarily complicated. But sustainable health is built on **simple daily habits** — small, consistent changes that make a powerful difference in weight, energy, and overall wellbeing.*

IN THIS ARTICLE

- 01** Include Fruits & Vegetables
- 02** Eat Produce First
- 03** Mindful Eating
- 04** Eat Slowly
- 05** Drink Water First

WRITTEN BY

Your Nutritionist

Helping clients build sustainable eating habits through evidence-based, practical nutrition guidance.

As a nutritionist, I often remind my clients that many people

believe they need strict meal plans or drastic changes to lose weight or maintain a healthy one. Here are five simple, evidence-based habits that can transform the way you eat.

01 **Always Include Fruits and Vegetables With Your Meals**

A balanced meal is one that nourishes the body with essential nutrients while also helping you feel satisfied. One of the easiest ways to achieve this is by always including fruits or vegetables alongside your meals.

Fruits and vegetables are packed with nutrients that support digestion, heart health, and immune function — while helping you feel full with fewer calories.

Dietary Fibre

Vitamins & Minerals

Antioxidants

Natural Water Content

Research consistently shows that diets rich in fruits and vegetables are associated with better weight management and reduced risk of chronic diseases. A helpful guideline: fill half your plate with vegetables or fruits whenever possible.

SIMPLE WAYS TO DO THIS

- Add berries, bananas, or apples to breakfast
- Include a side salad or steamed vegetables with lunch
- Add roasted or sautéed vegetables to dinner
- Choose fruit as a snack instead of processed options

Rather than focusing on restricting foods, start by adding more nourishing foods to your plate.

02 Eat Your Fruits and Vegetables First

This small shift can make a surprisingly big impact. Starting your meal with fruits or vegetables helps your body receive fibre and water early in the meal, which promotes fullness and slows digestion.

Fibre-rich foods help regulate blood sugar levels and support satiety — meaning you're less likely to overeat later in the meal.

TRY IT LIKE THIS

- Start dinner with a small salad
- Eat your vegetables before your rice, pasta, or protein
- Have a piece of fruit before reaching for dessert

Research in appetite regulation suggests that beginning meals

with low-energy, high-fibre foods can naturally reduce total calorie intake without requiring strict dieting. It's a simple strategy that works with your body's natural hunger signals.



*Sustainable nutrition is not about perfection — it's about building **healthy habits that work for your life.***

03 **Eat Without Distractions (Practice Mindful Eating)**

Many of us eat while scrolling on our phones, watching television, or working at our desks. While it may seem harmless, distracted eating often leads to mindless overeating.

When we eat while distracted, the brain does not fully register the meal. As a result, we may eat more than our body actually needs. Mindful eating encourages you to pay attention to the experience of eating, helping you recognise hunger and fullness signals more clearly.

MINDFUL EATING PRACTICES

- Put your phone away during meals
- Turn off the TV
- Sit down and focus on your food
- Notice the taste, texture, and aroma of each bite

When you eat with awareness, you often feel more satisfied with less food.

04 Eat Slowly

Your body needs time to communicate fullness to your brain. In fact, it typically takes about 20 minutes for satiety signals to develop. When meals are eaten too quickly, it's easy to consume more food before the body has time to signal that it's full.

Eating slowly allows your digestive system and appetite hormones to function properly.

PRACTICAL WAYS TO SLOW DOWN

- Take smaller bites
- Chew your food thoroughly
- Put your fork down between bites
- Pause halfway through the meal to check if you're still hungry

People who eat more slowly often find that they naturally eat less while feeling equally satisfied.

05 Drink Water First

One of the simplest habits for supporting healthy eating is drinking water before you eat. Sometimes the body confuses thirst with hunger — drinking water before meals can help ensure that what you're feeling is true hunger rather than dehydration.

Hydration also supports digestion, metabolism, and overall health. Some studies suggest that drinking water before meals may help reduce calorie intake, making it a simple yet powerful strategy for weight management.

TRY THIS SIMPLE HABIT

- 
- Drink a glass of water 10–15 minutes before meals
 - Start your morning with water before breakfast
 - Keep a water bottle nearby throughout the day

The Bottom Line

Healthy eating does not need to be complicated or restrictive. In fact, the most effective strategies are often the simplest. By practising these five habits consistently, you can:

- ✓ Improve your relationship with food
- ✓ Support a healthy weight
- ✓ Nourish your body with essential nutrients
- ✓ Reduce mindless overeating

Start with one habit at a time and allow it to become part of your daily routine. Over time, these small changes can lead to lasting improvements in both your health and wellbeing.

Remember: sustainable nutrition is not about perfection — it's about building healthy habits that work for your life.

